# THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

```
For any athlete building film and a public profile. Checked 2026-11-05.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot, playing time or income. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance office. `TO VERIFY` = not confirmed against a primary source on 2026-11-05.

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## 1. EVIDENCE, HONESTLY

- In football, a study of 2,644 Class of 2016 recruits found self-promotion on Twitter (like posting highlights) was associated with more offers (Zhao et al., *Big Data*, 2019). Association, not proof. No measured link exists yet for other sports.
- A 2015 survey of 600+ coaches: 83% searched athletes online; 17% of staffs had pulled an offer over online content (Cornerstone survey, 2015-08-19).

## 2. REEL STRUCTURE

| SPORT | LENGTH | ORDER |
|---|---|---|
| General | 3-5 min, 15-30 plays | Best 4-5 plays first; mark yourself every clip; info card first (NCSA, updated 2023-01-30) |
| Volleyball | 2-4 min | Organized by skill, labeled slides (Art of Coaching Volleyball, 2018-12-21) |
| Field hockey | ~5 min | No music; 2/3 game footage; circle the player (NFHCA, 2020-06-24) |
| Baseball | ≤5 min | Best first; verified numbers on card (NCSA baseball) |
| Social cut | 30-60 s | Short, frequent clips (Underwood thesis, 2025-04-30) |
| Basketball/soccer GK | Reel plus full games on request | Coach guidance |

## 3. ONE-PAGE PROFILE

Name · grad year · position/event · HS and club team · height/weight · verified measurables (source, date) · GPA/test if strong · email/phone · HS/club coach contact · film link.

## 4. SOCIAL AUDIT (DO IT EVERY SEASON)

- [ ] Search your own name; check every result
- [ ] Profile photo and bio match your profile page
- [ ] Pin the newest reel
- [ ] Remove anything you wouldn't show a head coach
- [ ] Follow target programs and staff

## 5. WHAT NOT TO POST

Anything involving alcohol, drugs, weapons, slurs, fights or mocking teammates or coaches. Don't post a coach's private messages. Don't post offer graphics for offers that aren't written.

## 6. WHEN COACHES MAY REPLY

Coaches can watch your posts any time, but D1 programs can't send you recruiting messages before their sport's date: June 15 after sophomore year generally (D1 Bylaw 13.4.1); Aug 1 junior year for baseball (13.4.1.1); Sept 1 junior year for women's lacrosse (13.4.1.2). A like or follow is not an offer.

## 7. TRACKERS

**Reel brief:** Sport · position · top 5 clips (game, date, timestamp) · info-card text · music: none

**Follow log**

| DATE | PROGRAM | STAFF MEMBER | FOLLOWS YOU? (CHECK MANUALLY) | ENGAGED WITH? | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

## 8. SOURCES


- Zhao et al. 2019: https://www.biz.uiowa.edu/faculty/kangzhao/pub/BigData_2019.pdf
- Cornerstone survey 2015: https://finance.yahoo.com/news/cornerstone-college-athletics-survey-reveals-131000575.html
- NCSA: https://www.ncsasports.org/blog/tips-creating-great-highlight-video ; Art of Coaching Volleyball; NFHCA https://nfhca.org/video-advice-from-college-coaches/ ; Underwood (Liberty, 2025).
- 2026-27 NCAA D1 Manual, LSDBi 90008, Bylaws 13.4.1, 13.4.1.1, 13.4.1.2 (checked 2026-11-05).